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B2B Thought Leadership Content Trends for 2026

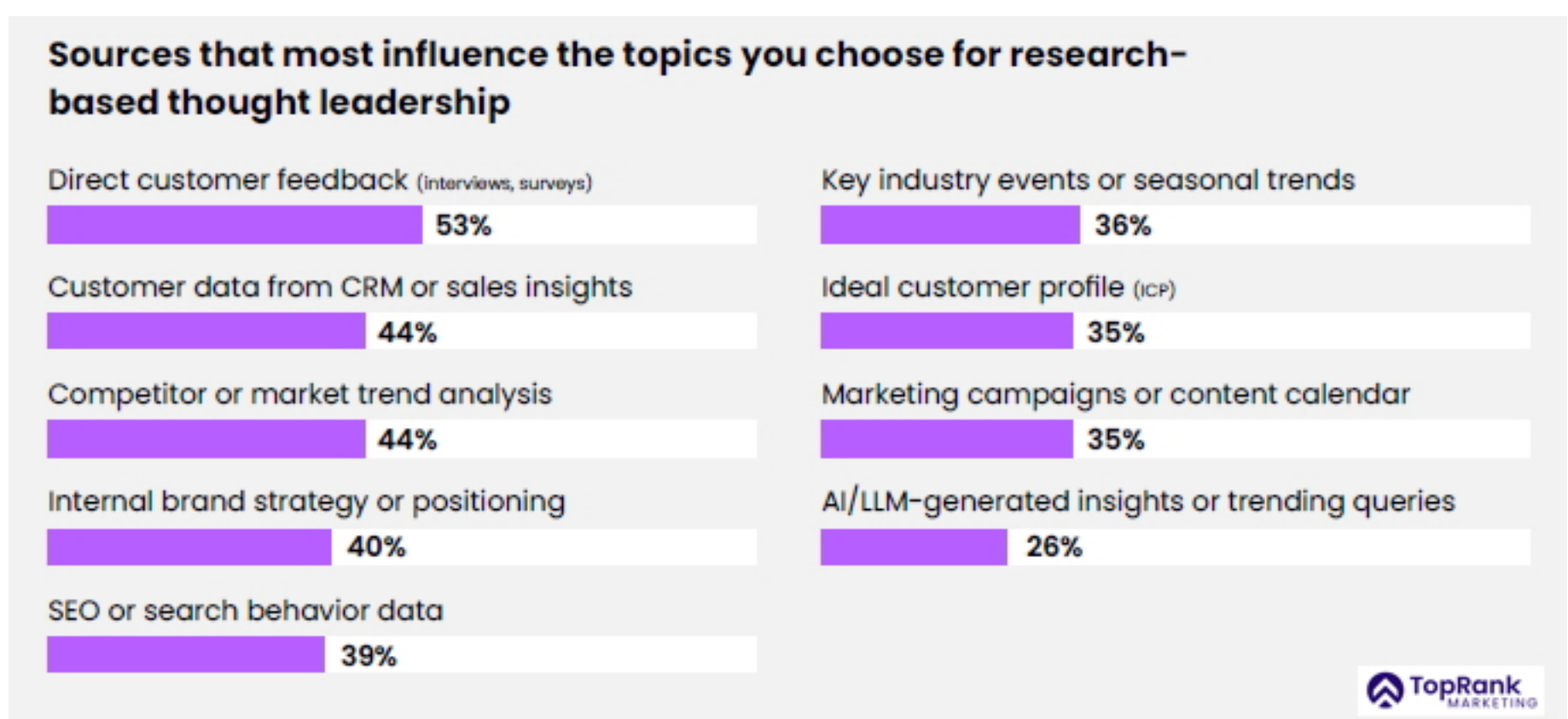
by [Ayaz Nanji](#)



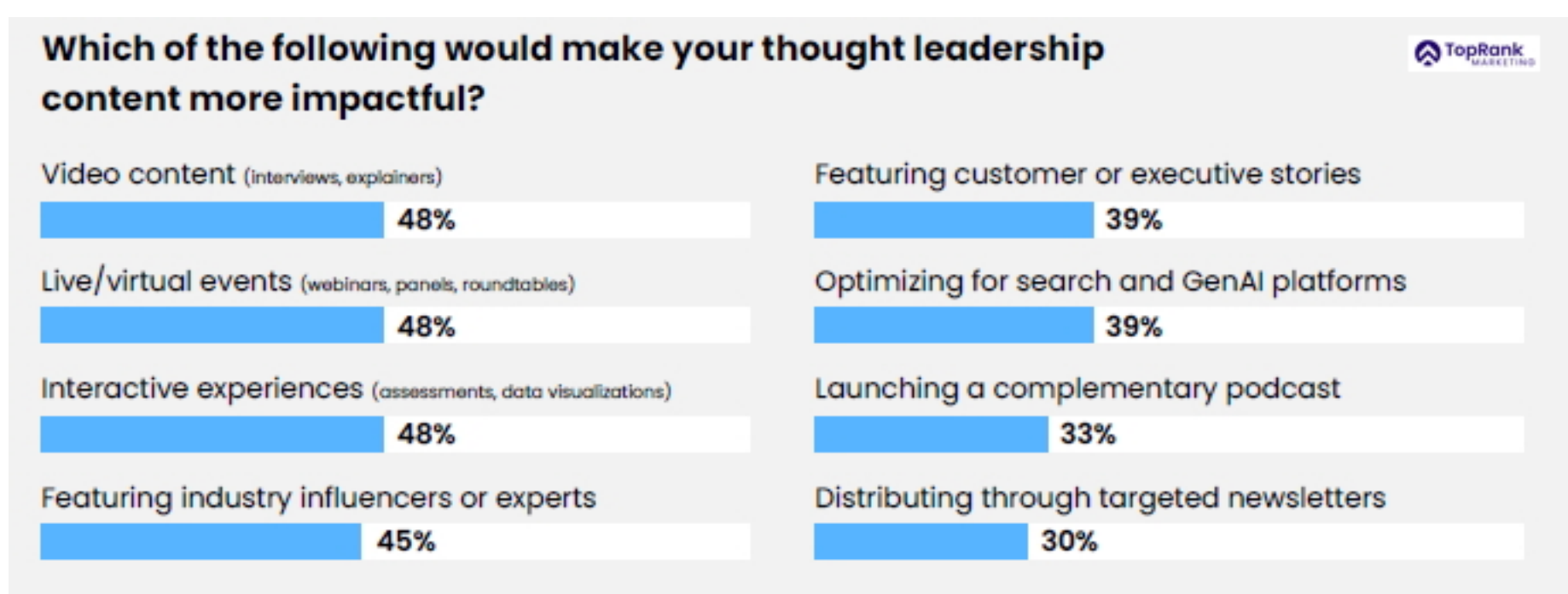
Some 47% of B2B marketers plan to increase their use of original research and data-driven thought leadership content in 2026, [according to](#) recent research from [TopRank Marketing](#) and [Ascend2](#).

[The report](#) was based on data from a survey of 797 senior-level marketing leaders who work for B2B companies in the United Kingdom or the United States.

Respondents say the sources that most influence which topics they cover in their research-based thought leadership content are customer feedback (53% cite), CRM data (44%), and marketing trend analysis (44%).



Respondents say their thought leadership content could be made more impactful by having more video content (48% cite), live/virtual events (48%), and interactive experiences (48%).



B2B marketers that report high ROI from their strategies are more likely to use thought leadership across all funnel stages compared with marketers who report low ROI from their efforts.



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High ROI marketers are more likely to use thought leadership across all funnel stages:

69% vs. 56%
awareness

64% vs. 48%
decision

47% vs. 28%
post-sale engagement

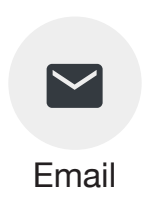
About the research: [The report](#) was based on data from a survey of 797 senior-level marketing leaders who work for B2B companies in the United Kingdom or the United States.

Published on January 6, 2026

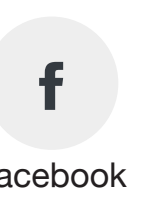
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